Friedrich-Alexander-Universität
Technische Fakultät

2. Introduction

Knowledge Discovery in Databases with Exercises

Dominik Probst, dominik.probst@fau.de
Computer Science 6 (Data Management), Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg
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Outline

1. **Why Data Mining?**

2. **What Is Data Mining?**

3. **A Multidimensional View of Data-Mining**
   - What Data Is Available?
   - What Patterns Are Searched For?
   - What Technologies Are Used?
   - What Is the Actual Target Application?

4. **Major Challenges in Data Mining**

5. **Summary**

Why Data Mining?

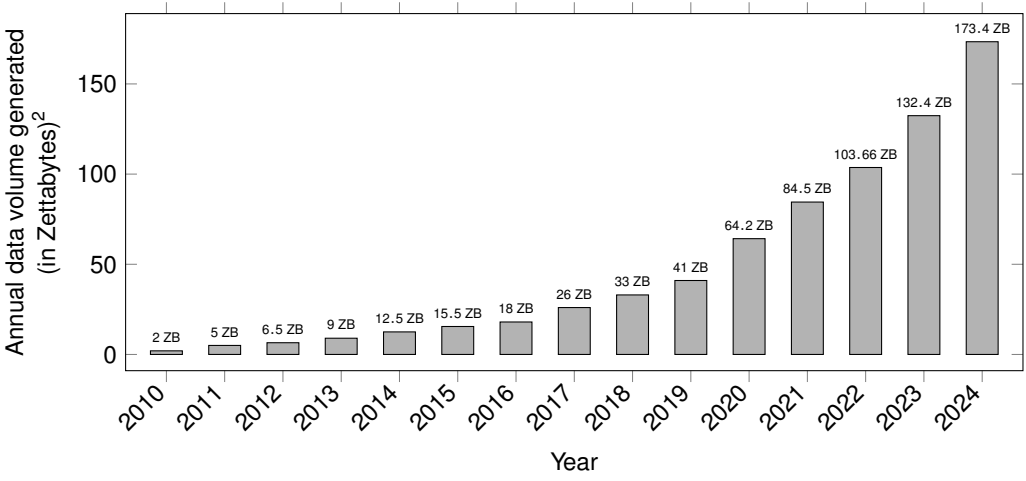
Why Data Mining? (I)

The explosive growth of data: from petabytes to exabytes to zettabytes[1] and beyond.

- Data collection and availability:
  - Automated data collection tools.
  - Database systems.
  - World wide web.
  - Computerized society.
  - Digitization.
- Major sources of abundant data:
  - Business: web, e-commerce, transactions, stocks ...
  - Science: remote sensing, bioinformatics, scientific simulation ...
  - Society: news, digital cameras, social media ...
- The era of **big data** (as inflationary used buzzword).

[1] 1 Zettabyte = 1,000,000,000,000,000,000,000 Byte (21 Zeros!)

Why Data Mining? (II)



[2]Source: https://de.statista.com/statistik/daten/studie/267974/umfrage/prognose-zum-weltweit-generierten-datenvolumen/ (Last checked: June 9, 2026)

Why Data Mining? (III)

The initial situation:

- We are drowning in data
- We are starving for knowledge

The basic idea behind data mining:

- We can analyze the data to satisfy our hunger for knowledge

What Is Data Mining?

What Is Data Mining?

Data mining or knowledge discovery from data:

- Extraction of interesting (**non-trivial, implicit, previously unknown and potentially useful**) patterns from huge amounts of data.
- Is **data mining** a misnomer?

Alternative names:

- Knowledge discovery/mining in databases (KDD).
- Knowledge extraction.
- Data/pattern analysis.
- Data archeology/dredging.
- Information harvesting.
- Business intelligence.

Examples: Is Everything Data Mining?

Considered to be data mining:

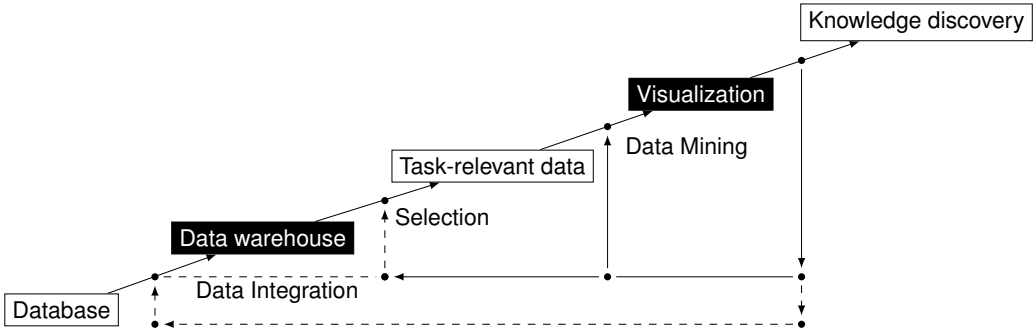
- Analysis of customer behavior for user-related advertising.
- Analysis of payment histories for fraud detection.
- Analysis of infection behavior for better understanding of a pandemic.

NOT considered to be data mining:

- Simple search for females in a customer database.
- Simple join of two database tables.
- Simple deductive database validating a new tuple with regards to predefined constraints.

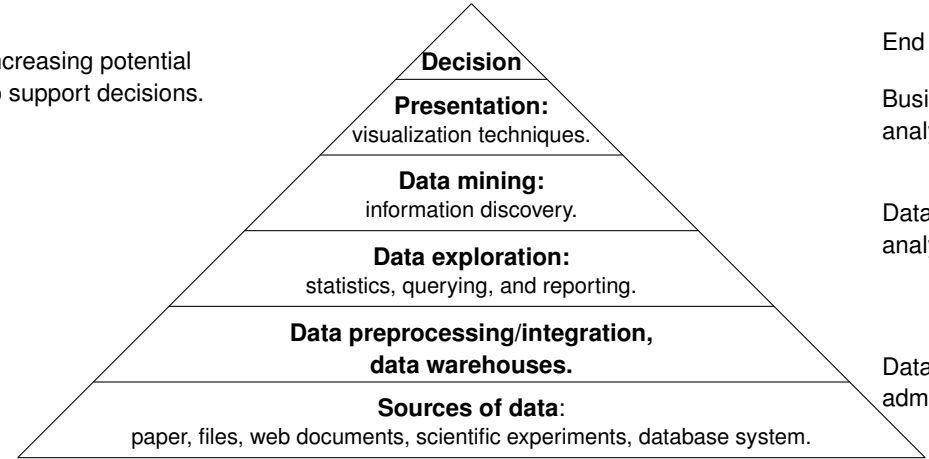
Data Mining in the Database Community

- The **Knowledge discovery pipeline** is a typical view from the database community.
- Data mining plays an essential role in the knowledge-discovery process.



Data Mining in the Business Community

Increasing potential
to support decisions.



End user.

Business analyst.

Data analyst.

Database administration.

Data Mining in the ML Community

The Machine Learning community usually classifies data mining as the central part of its pipeline:



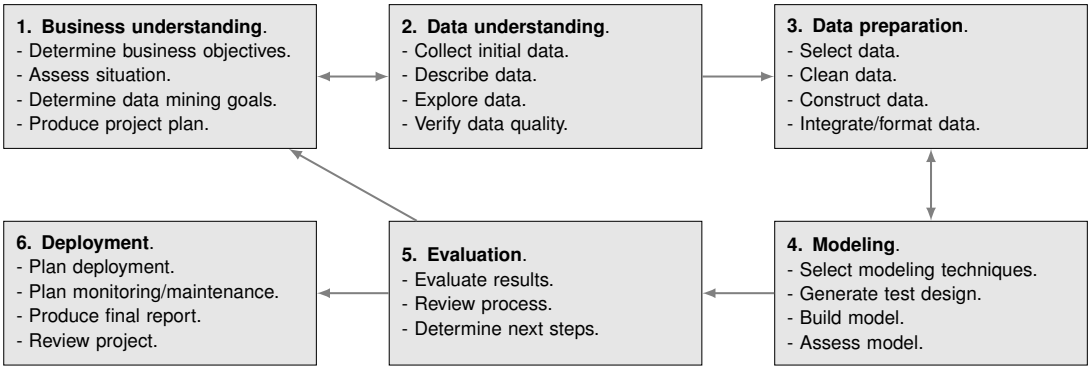
- Data integration.
- Normalization.
- Feature selection.
- Dimension reduction.

- Pattern discovery.
- Association/correlation.
- Classification.
- Clustering.
- Outlier analysis.
- ...

- Pattern evaluation.
- Pattern selection.
- Pattern interpretation.
- Pattern visualization.

The Data Mining Process: CRISP-DM

- **CRoss-Industry Standard Process for Data Mining**:



A Multidimensional View of Data-Mining

Data mining projects can be described in four dimensions:

- **What data is available?**:
  Data can exist in a wide variety of forms and must therefore be treated differently in data mining.
- **What patterns are searched for?**:
  Various functions in data mining can be used to detect different patterns.
- **What technologies are used?**:
  The technologies used can vary greatly in data mining.
- **What is the actual target application?**:
  The actual target application also differs from case to case.

A Multidimensional View of Data-Mining

What Data Is Available?

What Kind of Data Can Be Mined? (I)

- **Any kind of data as long as meaningful for the target application.**
- Most basic forms of data sources:
  - **Relational database:**
    Collection of tables, where the tables consist of a set of attributes and usually a large set of tuples.
  - **Data warehouse:**
    Repository of information collected from multiple sources, stored under a unified schema.
  - **Transactional database:**
    Captures transactions, such as customer purchases, flight bookings, or user clicks on a website.

What Kind of Data Can Be Mined? (II)

Advanced data sets and advanced applications:

- Data streams and sensor data.
- Time series data, temporal data, sequence data (incl. biosequences).
- Structure data, graphs, social networks and multi-linked data.
- Object-relational databases.
- Heterogeneous databases and legacy databases.
- NoSQL databases.
- Spatial data and spatiotemporal data.
- Multimedia databases.
- Text databases.
- The world wide web.

A Multidimensional View of Data-Mining

What Patterns Are Searched For?

What Kind of Patterns Can Be Mined?

- **Searching for the right patterns is important.**
- Which patterns can be mined depends on:
  - **Data mining function.**
    Different functions can reveal different patterns.
  - **Data set.**
    Some types of records contain special patterns that can be found only in them.
- Patterns do not always lead to useful information.
  $\rightarrow$ Always validate whether the gained knowledge is interesting.

Data Mining Functions: Examples

Some will be covered in this lecture:

- Data Transformations → *Lectures 3, 4, and 5*
- Frequent Pattern Analysis → *Lecture 6*
- Classification → *Lecture 7*
- Clustering → *Lecture 8*
- Outlier Analysis → *Lecture 9*

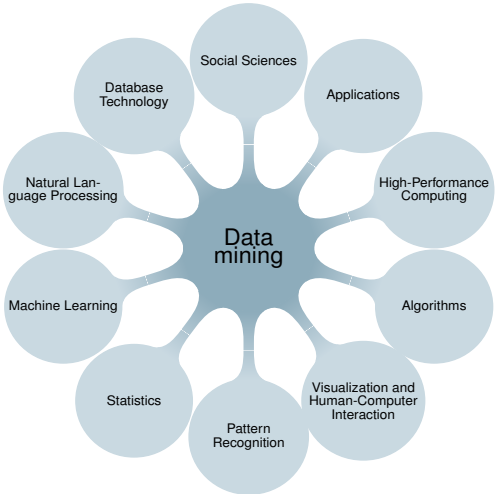
But where are many more. E.g.:

- Network Analysis
- Web Mining
- Time Series Analysis
- Neural Networks
- . . .

A Multidimensional View of Data-Mining

What Technologies Are Used?

Confluence of Multiple Disciplines



Why Confluence of Multiple Disciplines?

Each discipline contributes something different. E.g.:

- **Algorithms:**
  Basic algorithms to get started.
- **Machine Learning:**
  Specialized algorithms for learning from data.
- **High-Performance computing:**
  Parallel and distributed computing to handle large datasets.
- **Database Technologies:**
  Efficent storage and retrieval of data.
- **Etc.:**
  . . .

A Multidimensional View of Data-Mining

What Is the Actual Target Application?

Applications of Data Mining (I)

- **Wherever there is data and more knowledge is desired, there are data mining applications.**
- Typical data mining applications:
  - **Business Intelligence**
    Provides historical, current, and predictive views of business operation.
  - **Web Search Engines**
    Need to decide which pages to index, which ones to index and how to rank them for search.
  - **Fraud detection**
    Possible fraud attempts automatically based on suspicious patterns in transactions.
  - **Predictive Maintenance**
    Evaluation of sensor data to maintain machines in time before a defect occurs.

Applications of Data Mining (II)

- Example research projects using data mining at FAU[3]:
  - **Prediction of product properties using data mining methods.**
    Prof. Dr.-Ing. Sandro Wartzack (Chair of Engineering Design)
  - **Combustion and fuel optimization for the utilization of residues in biomass furnaces.**
    Prof. Dr.-Ing. Jürgen Karl (Chair of Energy Process Engineering)
  - **CoralTrace – A new approach to understanding climate-induced reef crises.**
    Prof. Dr. Wolfgang Kießling (Chair of Palaeontology)
  - **Performance Analysis in Team Sports.**
    Prof. Dr. Björn Eskofier (Machine Learning and Data Analytics Lab)
  - **And many more.**
    Chair of computer science 6 (data management) has some projects related to data mining, too. More information will be given in the last lecture.

[3] Found in the FAU CRIS (Current research information system): `https://cris.fau.de/`

Major Challenges in Data Mining

Major Challenges in Data Mining (I)

Mining methodology:

- Mining various and new kinds of knowledge.
- Mining knowledge in multi-dimensional space.
- Data mining: An interdisciplinary effort.
- Boosting the power of discovery in a networked environment.
- Handling noise, uncertainty, and incompleteness of data.
- Pattern evaluation and pattern- or constraint-guided mining.

User interaction:

- Interactive mining.
- Incorporation of background knowledge.
- Presentation and visualization of data mining results.

Major Challenges in Data Mining (II)

Efficiency and scalability:

- Efficiency and scalability of data-mining algorithms.
- Parallel, distributed, stream and incremental mining methods.

Diversity of data types:

- Handling complex types of data.
- Mining dynamic, networked and global data repositories.

Data mining and society:

- Social impacts of data mining.
- Privacy-preserving data mining.
- Invisible data mining.

Summary

Summary

In this lecture:

- **Data Mining:**
  Discovering interesting patterns and knowledge from massive amounts of data.
- **Data Mining Process:**
  Every community focusses on different aspects.
- **Important Aspects:**
  What Data? What Patterns? What Technologies? What Applications?
- **Challenges:**
  A lot of things to consider.

Any questions about this chapter?

Ask them now or ask them later in our forum:



https://www.studon.fau.de/studon/goto.php?target=lcode_kh3JHJdN

Appendix

Evolution of Sciences (I)

- Before 1600, era of **empirical science**.
- 1600 — 1950s, rise of **theoretical science**.
  - Each discipline has grown a theoretical component.
  - Theoretical models often motivate experiments and generalize our understanding.
- 1950 — 1990s, rise of **computational science**.
  - Over the last 50 years most disciplines have grown a third, computational branch.
    - E.g. empirical, theoretical, and computational ecology.
    - E.g. physics, linguistics or biology.
  - Computational science traditionally meant simulation.
  - It grew out of our inability to describe reality by closed-form mathematical models.

Evolution of Sciences (II)

- 1990−now, rise of **data science**.
  - The flood of data from new instruments and modern simulations.
  - The ability to economically store and manage petabytes of data.
  - The internet makes all these archives world wide accessible.
  - Scientific *information management*,
    acquisition,
    organization,
    query, and
    visualization scale almost linearly with amount of data.
  - **Data mining** is a major new challenge!
- For further reading:
  Jim Gray and Alex Szaly: *The World Wide Telescope: An Archetype for Online Science*,
  Communications of the ACM 45(11): 50-54, 2002.

Evolution of Sciences (III)

- 1960s: Data collection, database creation,
  integrated management systems (IMS), and
  network database management systems (DBMS).
- 1970s: Relational data model, relational DBMS implementation (RDBMS).
- 1980s: RDBMS products, database creation,
  advanced data models (extended relational, object oriented, deductive etc.),
  application-oriented DBMS (spatial, scientific, engineering etc.).
- 1990s: Data mining, data warehousing, multimedia databases, web databases.
- 2000s: Stream data management and mining,
  data mining and applications,
  web technology (XML, data integration), and global information systems.

A Brief History of Data Mining Society

- **1989 IJCAI Workshop on Knowledge Discovery in Databases:**
  Knowledge Discovery in Databases (G. Piatetsky-Shapiro and W. Frawley, 1991).
- **1991-1994 Workshops on Knowledge Discovery in Databases:**
  Advances in Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (U. Fayyad, G. Piatetsky-Shapiro, P. Smyth and R. Uthurusamy, 1996).
- **1995-1998 International Conferences on Knowledge Discovery in Databases and Data Mining (KDD'95-98):**
  Journal of Data Mining and Knowledge Discovery (1997).
- **ACM SIGKDD conferences since 1998 and SIGKDD Explorations.**
- **More conferences on data mining:**
  PAKDD (1997), PKDD (1997), SIAM-Data Mining (2001), (IEEE) ICDM (2001), etc.
- **Journal ACM Transactions on KDD starting in 2007**.

Conferences and Journals on Data Mining (I)

KDD Conferences:

- ACM SIGKDD Int. Conf. on Knowledge Discovery in Databases and Data Mining (KDD).
- SIAM Data Mining Conf. (SDM).
- (IEEE) Int. Conf. on Data Mining (ICDM).
- European Conf. on Machine Learning and Principles and Practices of Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (ECML-PKDD).
- Pacific-Asia Conf. on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (PAKDD).
- Int. Conf. on Web Search and Data Mining (WSDM).

Conferences and Journals on Data Mining (II)

Other related conferences:

- DB conferences: ACM SIGMOD, VLDB, ICDE, EDBT, ICDT, ...
- Web and IR conferences: WWW, SIGIR, WSDM, ...
- ML conferences: ICML, NIPS, ICLR ...
- PR conferences: CVPR, ICPR ...

Journals:

- Data Mining and Knowledge Discovery (DAMI or DMKD).
- IEEE Trans. On Knowledge and Data Eng. (TKDE).
- KDD Explorations.
- ACM Trans. on KDD.

Starting points to Find References? (I)

Data mining and KDD (SIGKDD: CD-ROM):

- Conferences: ACM-SIGKDD, IEEE-ICDM, SIAM-DM, PKDD, PAKDD, etc.
- Journal: Data Mining and Knowledge Discovery, KDD Explorations, ACM TKDD.
- KDnuggets: `www.kdnuggets.com`.

Database systems (SIGMOD: ACM SIGMOD Anthology CD-ROM):

- Conferences: ACM-SIGMOD, ACM-PODS, VLDB, IEEE-ICDE, EDBT, ICDT, DASFAA.
- Journals: IEEE-TKDE, ACM-TODS/TOIS, JIIS, J. ACM, VLDB J., Info. Sys., etc.

AI & Machine Learning:

- Conferences: Machine learning (ML), AAAI, IJCAI, COLT (Learning Theory), CVPR, NIPS, etc.
- Journals: Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Knowledge and Information Systems, IEEE-PAMI, etc.

Starting points to Find References? (II)

Web and IR:

- Conferences: SIGIR, WWW, CIKM, etc.
- Journals: WWW: Internet and Web Information Systems.

Statistics:

- Conferences: Joint Stat. Meeting, etc.
- Journals: Annals of Statistics, etc.

Visualization:

- Conferences: CHI, ACM-SIGGraph, etc.
- Journals: IEEE Trans. Visualization and Computer Graphics, etc.